



MGTA01H3
Introduction to Business
Fall 2025

Instructor Contact Information:

Name: Maria Shibaeva

Office: IC 273 (*Office*) / **IC 200B** (*Group Meeting Room for Office Hours*)

Office hours:

Wednesdays 10am-12pm

Thursdays 10am-12pm

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Telephone: (416) 729-1882 (*WhatsApp preferred*)

Class day/time: Mondays 10:00 am - 12:00 pm

Class location: IC130

Course website: Quercus

Course Description & Learning Outcomes/Objectives:

This course serves as a foundational introduction to the world of business, including the role businesses play in the Canadian economy, the planning and creation of businesses, and issues that are of relevance to Canadian business managers in the 21st century.

Students will develop a broad and deep understanding of various topics related to business, such as: the characteristics of businesses, the purpose and motivation of businesses, the goods and services that businesses provide, the raw materials from which every business is made, the role of businesses in the Canadian economy and society, how businesses function in the market, types of market structures, how to measure economic performance, why and how to start a business, what is required for businesses to succeed, the various ways in which businesses are financed, and more!

Prerequisite(s):

None

Textbook/Required Course Materials:

Introduction to Canadian Business
Second Edition
Chris Bovaird
McGraw Hill Ryerson

It is understood that you will read and consider all the assigned reading. The reading will be **briefly** reviewed in class, and your attention will be drawn to the highlights and principal arguments in each topic. Where you have difficulties or disagreements with a reading, or where you find a reading particularly interesting, it is expected that you will raise this as a discussion point, in class.

Lecture Notes and Other Announcements:

Lecture Modules & Announcements will be posted online through the Course website on Quercus.

Overall Evaluation and Grading:

Component	Weight/Value	Due Date
Individual Reflection Paper	30%	Week 8
Midterm Exam	30%	Week 6-Week 7 (TBC by Registrar's Office)
Final Exam	40%	During Final Exam Period

Assignment Information to be shared Week 1-2

A MINIMUM of 20% of the Total Grade will be deducted, if student fails to provide proper citation/quotation/paraphrase in their work, and the incident will be reported to the Academic Integrity Office.

Individual Reflection Paper (30%)

Over the course of the semester, you will be required to write one “**Individual Reflection Paper**”. This is NOT a Literature Review. I want to see evidence that you have read, thought about, and APPLIED the arguments from the reading to your OWN IDEAS, EXPERIENCES, and OPINIONS. Details of the Individual Reflection Paper will be presented throughout the term.

Midterm Exam (30%)

The Midterm Exam will take place in-class during Week #6-Week #7 (TBC by Registrar's Office). It will focus on TO-DATE class lectures, discussions, slides, and assigned textbook readings. It may consist of multiple-choice questions, short answer questions, as well as mini case studies. More information regarding the Midterm Exam will be shared throughout the term.

Final Exam (40%)

The Final Exam will take place in-class during the Final Exam Period (as assigned by Registrar's Office). It will focus on CUMULATIVE class lectures, discussions, slides, and assigned textbook readings. It may consist of multiple-choice questions, short answer questions, as well as mini case studies. More information regarding the Final Exam will be shared throughout the term.

Recording of Course/Classroom Material by Students

Recording or photographing any aspect of a university course - lecture, tutorial, seminar, lab, studio, practice session, field trip, etc. – without prior approval of all involved and without written approval from the instructor is not permitted.

NOTE -- To ensure a SAFE SPACE FOR Q&A AND OPEN DISCUSSION, LECTURES WILL NOT BE RECORDED.

Course-specific Accommodations:

Accommodation on *a short-term basis* (i.e. one to two weeks), in case of short-term health/emergency reasons, will be provided. A complete set of Lecture Slides, including solutions to class exercises/case studies, will be provided.

Policy on Missed Assignments/Examinations:

You are responsible for submitting your Assignments on-time. If there is a health/emergency reason (WITH PROOF/DOCUMENTATION) that you cannot submit your Assignment on-time, you MUST contact your Professor IN-ADVANCE of the Assignment deadline, to arrange accommodations. If you do not contact your Professor IN-ADVANCE of the Assignment deadline, NO ACCOMMODATIONS will be available to you, and this will result in a Grade of 0.

You are responsible for checking your Marks when they are posted on Quercus. If you do not contact your Professor about any Marks issues on Quercus, **within 48-hours of the Posting Date (Assignments) or within 48-hours of the Exam Viewing Date (Exams)**, NO ADJUSTMENTS will be available to you.

Statement on Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion (EDI)

The University of Toronto is committed to equity, human rights and respect for diversity. All members of the learning environment in this course should strive to create an atmosphere of mutual respect where all members of our community can express themselves, engage with each other, and respect one another's differences. U of T does not condone discrimination or harassment against any persons or communities.

If you have questions or concerns on issues related to EDI, please contact the Equity, Diversity and Inclusion Office: <https://www.utoronto.ca/edio/>

Academic Support

Office Hours:

Office hours for individual consultation with students who have problems or questions that cannot be discussed in the class sessions will be announced by the instructor in Quercus.

Questions relating to administrative, registration, degree/program requirements should be directed to the academic advising team:

Management programs/courses: mgmtss@utsc.utoronto.ca.

Economics programs/courses: ecoss.utsc@utoronto.ca.

UTSC Library:

Management students can access library services at The BRIDGE, located in IC 108. The BRIDGE offers programs and services to support students, staff, and faculty in their studies, research projects, and experiential learning initiatives. <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/thebridge/>

Visit The BRIDGE to:

- Access the finance & data lab, including specialized software and Bloomberg terminals
- Participate in events and competitions
- Get research and data analytics help
- Access data and academic research tools and tutorials
- Get support in entrepreneurship and the New Venture Program
- Learn more about Work Integrated Learning

To find out more about the UTSC Library's support for students visit: <https://utsc.library.utoronto.ca/>

For all other inquiries, please email thebridge@utsc.utoronto.ca or email your Liaison Librarian, Mariana Jardim mariana.jardim@utoronto.ca

Health & Wellness Centre:

The Health & Wellness Centre provides professional and confidential medical, nursing, counselling, health promotion, and education services to all UTSC students. These services are offered in a safe, caring, respectful, and empowering environment that is directed toward optimizing your personal, academic, and overall wellbeing.. To access these services, please use the following url: <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/hwc/> and when visiting the Health & Wellness Centre, please bring a valid T-card and Health card.

Academic Advising and Career Centre:

The Academic Advising and Career Centre (AA&CC) at UTSC integrates developmental advising, learning/study skills, career counselling, and employment coaching. To reach out to them please use the following url: <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/aacc/>

Quercus – UTSC Learning Management System

To access Quercus, please visit: <https://q.utoronto.ca>

If you need help getting started? Visit the Quercus Help Page to access tip-sheets and other helpful resources.

For additional questions, contact the Ed Tech team at quercus@utsc.utoronto.ca.

For frequently asked questions, please visit: <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/technology/faq-students>

AccessAbility Services

The University provides academic accommodations for students with disabilities in accordance with the terms of the Ontario Human Rights Code. This occurs through a collaborative process that acknowledges a collective obligation to develop an accessible learning environment that both meets the needs of students and preserves the essential academic requirements of the University's courses and programs.

Students with diverse learning styles and needs are welcome in this course. If you have a disability that may require accommodations, please feel free to approach me and/or the Accessibility Services office. <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/ability/welcome-accessability-services>

The Centre of Teaching and Learning

The Centre for Teaching and Learning (CTL) is available to support you in your writing, math and stats, and English language needs. It offers online and in-person tutoring and consultations and has a variety of helpful resources.

English Language Development Centre:

The English Language Development Centre (ELDC) helps students develop the critical thinking, vocabulary and academic communication skills essential for achieving academic and professional success. Personalized support includes: RWE (for academic writing); Communication Cafés (oral); Discussion Skill-Building Cafés; Vocabulary Cafés; seminars/workshops; personal ELD consultations; drop-in sessions. <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/ctl/english-language-development-support>

The Writing Centre:

The Writing Centre (TWC) offers invaluable services to students (learn to become a better writer!) and offers many different kinds of help: drop-in sessions, individual consultations, workshops, clinics, and online writing handouts. <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/ctl/writing-support>

Other Support:

For more information regarding other academic support from the university, please visit CTL's Student Resource Centre at AC313 or check out <https://www.utsc.utoronto.ca/ctl/academic-learning-support>.

Use of Generative AI in Assignments



Can use Generative AI in certain instances/specific ways

- Students may use artificial intelligence tools for gathering information for an assignment, but the final submitted assignment must be original work produced by the individual student alone.
- Thus, while AI tools may be useful when gathering information from across different sources and assimilating it, to contribute to your understanding of the materials, you may not use AI tools for completing/writing course assignments.
- If AI tools are used (for the purpose of information gathering – as per above), this use must be documented in an appendix for each assignment. The documentation should include what tool(s) were used, how they were used, the prompt that was used to generate the content, and how the results from the AI were incorporated into the submitted work.
- Representing as one's own an idea, or expression of an idea, that was AI-generated may be considered an academic offense in this course.
- NOTE: Many organizations that publish standard citation formats are now providing information on citing generative AI (e.g., MLA: <https://style.mla.org/citing-generative-ai/>).
- Students may NOT use AI tools for taking tests/exams in this course.
- This course policy is designed to promote your learning and intellectual development and to help you reach course learning outcomes.

Academic Misconduct

Academic integrity is essential to the pursuit of learning and scholarship in a university. The University treats cases of cheating and plagiarism very seriously. The University of Toronto's Code of Behaviour on Academic Matters (<http://www.governingcouncil.utoronto.ca/Assets/Governing+Council+Digital+Assets/Policies/PDF/pjun011995.pdf>) outlines the behaviours that constitute academic dishonesty and the processes for addressing academic offences. Any student caught engaging in such activities will be subject to academic discipline ranging from a mark of zero on the assignment, test or examination to dismissal from the university as outlined in the Code of Behavior on Academic Matters. Any student abetting or otherwise assisting in such misconduct will also be subject to academic penalties. If you like to find out more information regarding university advice for 'How not to plagiarize', please use the following url: <https://advice.writing.utoronto.ca/using-sources/how-not-to-plagiarize/>

More generally, the link below includes a lot of useful advice for students on academic writing:

<https://advice.writing.utoronto.ca/>

For information and resources on Academic Integrity, visit: <https://www.uts.utoronto.ca/vpdean/faq-0>

Detailed Course Outline:

DATE	TOPIC	READINGS	DUE DATES
Monday, Sept 1 -- NO CLASS (Labour Day)			
Week 1 (Sept 8)	Introduction to Course / What is a Business?	• Chapter 1	
Week 2 (Sept 15)	Products: The Things That People Need and Want	• Chapter 2	
Week 3 (Sept 22)	Creating Businesses & Products: The Factors of Production	• Chapter 3	
Week 4 (Sept 29)	Economic Systems: Who Owns and Controls The Factors of Production?	• Chapter 4	
Week 5 (Oct 6)	When Buyers & Sellers Interact – How Markets Work	• Chapter 5	
Monday, Oct 13 -- NO CLASS (Thanksgiving)			
Week 6 (Oct 20)	MIDTERM EXAM	• No Reading	
READING WEEK (Oct 27-Oct 31)			
Week 7 (Nov 3)	Understanding and Measuring The Business Environment	• Chapter 6	
Week 8 (Nov 10)	Enterprises & Entrepreneurs: The Many Businesses of Canada & The People Who Start Them	• Chapter 7	INDIVIDUAL REFLECTION PAPER DUE
Week 9 (Nov 17)	Planning & Organizing The Business: Simple Forms of Ownership	• Chapter 8	
Week 10 (Nov 24)	Organizing The Business: Corporations	• Chapter 9	
Week 11 (Dec 1)	Industry Guest Speaker <i>(subject to date change pending availability)</i>	• No Reading	
Week 12 (TUESDAY , Dec 2)	Financing The Business + Course Review & Open Class Discussion	• Chapter 10	
FINAL EXAM – During Final Exam Period (as assigned by Registrar's Office)			

Due to the volatile nature of managing external Guest Speaker schedules, any classes with external Guest Speakers are subject to date change.

Other materials and/or Guest Speakers to supplement select topics may be introduced on a need basis or upon special interest from the class.